

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

Interconnection of Large Loads to the) Docket No. RM26-4-000
Interstate Transmission System)

**REPLY COMMENTS OF
RWE CLEAN ENERGY, LLC**

On October 23, the Department of Energy (“DOE”) issued a directive for the Commission to initiate an Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking focused on reforms to the interconnection processes for large loads interconnecting to the interstate transmission system (“ANOPR”).¹ Pursuant to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission’s (“FERC” or the “Commission”) October 27, 2025 Notice Inviting Comments regarding the ANOPR (“October 27 Notice”) and November 7, 2025 Notice Granting Extension of Time in the above-referenced proceeding, RWE Clean Energy, LLC (“RWECE”) respectfully submits these Reply Comments.

I. REPLY COMMENTS

The ANOPR resulted in approximately 200 intervenors, of which many submitted comments to the fourteen (14) principles for reform.² RWECE provides responses to comments submitted by American Electric Power Service Corporation (“AEP”) that focused on the “entry-fee” concept.³

A. RWECE Supports AEP’s Entry Fee Concept

American Electric Power Service Corporation (“AEP”) comments suggested the Commission should adopt an “entry fee” model where generation developers pay a standardized

¹ *Ensuring the Timely and Orderly Interconnection of Large Loads*, Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (ANOPR) (October 23, 2025).

² ANOPR at Section V.

³ RWECE’s comments are not exclusive and should not be read to imply agreement with or adoption of every ANOPR principle or intervenor comments that are not the subject of these comments.

or formulaic fee or charge to cover their interconnection costs.⁴ AEP proposes that this fee should be known to the developer prior to submission of its interconnection request. As AEP describes, because generation project developers will have certainty regarding cost responsibility upfront, this “entry fee” model reduces network upgrade cost uncertainty, which can impede the interconnection process and inhibit the timely interconnection of new generation. AEP’s comments detail how the “entry fee” could be determined, how a fee could be structured, and how it could be paid by the interconnecting party.

RWECE supports such an “entry fee” concept for its potential to provide certainty to project developers, both load and hybrid facilities (“LAHF”) and generation, and avoid projects which seek to identify low-cost interconnection locations but are rarely constructed, as AEP describes.⁵ Implementing new interconnection mechanisms quickly is important as well. For example, the “entry fee” proposal that has been developed by Southwest Power Pool, Inc. (“SPP”) took several years to be developed and filed at FERC, and is currently pending FERC approval.⁶ Initial development of the concept and ultimate proposal began at SPP through creation of an SPP Consolidated Planning Process Task Force in 2021.⁷ The SPP proposal will likely not be ruled upon by FERC until 2026.

RWECE believes that solutions which require more than 4 years to complete do not address the issues identified in the ANOPR. For the immediate need, RWECE believes that

⁴ Comments of American Electric Power Service Corporation at pp. 10-15, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Nov. 21, 2025) (“AEP comments”).

⁵ AEP initial comments at pp. 11-12 (describing iterative study processes and speculative interconnection request practices that are currently common and which cause cost uncertainty for developers).

⁶ *Sw. Power Pool, Inc.*, Submission of Revisions to the SPP Open Access Transmission Tariff to Implement the Consolidated Planning Process, Docket No. ER26-414-000 (filed Nov. 3, 2025).

⁷ SPP Consolidated Planning Process Task Force, *Organization Group Scope Statement*, Southwest Power Pool, Inc. (Oct. 4, 2021), available at:

<https://www.spp.org/documents/66117/cpptf%20scope%20final%2011292021.pdf>.

solutions, including the crediting mechanism methodology identified in Principle #8 of the ANOPR,⁸ and which RWECE supported in its initial comments,⁹ can and should be implemented much faster than four years to meet the objective of this acceleration initiative. For the longer term, the crediting mechanism should be replaced with an “entry fee” concept, which provides certainty and reduced risks for LAHF and generation participants.

II. CONCLUSION

RWECE respectfully requests that the Commission take these reply comments into account in its consideration of the Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking in this proceeding.

Respectfully submitted,

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⁸ ANOPR at P 25.

⁹ Comments of RWE Clean Energy, LLC at pp. 6-9, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Nov. 21, 2025).